QuarryChain Brand Style Guide

Version 1.0 — April 2026

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1. Brand Overview

QuarryChain is a Layer 1 blockchain network built on Delegated Proof of Stake (DPoS) consensus. The brand communicates **speed, decentralization, and developer confidence** through a futuristic dark-mode visual language.

Brand Positioning: A top-tier L1 blockchain that doesn't need to justify itself. We state, we don't explain. We show capability, not comparison.

Brand Personality:

- Confident, not arrogant
- Technical, not exclusionary
- Punchy, not hype-bro
- Premium, not flashy

Tagline: *None currently in use. The brand speaks through product, not slogans.*

2. Logo Usage

Primary Logo

The QuarryChain logo consists of a **geometric icon mark** paired with a **wordmark** in the display typeface (Space Grotesk Bold).

Wordmark Treatment:

- "Quarry" renders in **brand blue (#3b82f6)**
- "Chain" renders in **primary white (#f1f5f9)**
- Always presented together — never separate the color split

Logo Variants

Variant	Use Case
Icon + Wordmark	Primary use — navbar, hero, deck covers
Icon Only	Favicons, social avatars, app icons
Wordmark Only	Footer, document headers

Clear Space

Maintain minimum clear space equal to the height of the icon mark on all sides.

Minimum Size

- Icon + Wordmark: 120px wide minimum
- Icon Only: 24px minimum

Logo Don'ts

- Never stretch, skew, or rotate the logo
- Never place on busy backgrounds without a dark overlay
- Never change the blue/white color split
- Never add drop shadows, outlines, or effects
- Never use the old colorful/clipart logo

3. Color Palette

Backgrounds

Token	Hex	RGB	Usage
bg-primary	#08080f	8, 8, 15	Page background — near-black with blue undertone
bg-secondary	#0f1019	15, 16, 25	Card backgrounds, code blocks
bg-tertiary	#161822	22, 24, 34	Elevated surfaces, hover states

Brand Colors

Token	Hex	RGB	Usage
qc-teal	#14b8a6	20, 184, 166	**Primary accent** — CTAs, labels, grid glow
qc-teal-glow	#2dd4bf	45, 212, 191	Bright accent, hover states
qc-blue	#3b82f6	59, 130, 246	Primary actions, links, "Quarry" in wordmark
qc-blue-glow	#60a5fa	96, 165, 250	Hover states, secondary accent
qc-red	#ef4444	239, 68, 68	Alerts, emphasis, urgency
qc-red-muted	#dc2626	220, 38, 38	Secondary emphasis
qc-green	#22c55e	34, 197, 94	Success, eco messaging, confirmations
qc-green-muted	#16a34a	22, 163, 74	Secondary success

Text Colors

Token	Hex	Usage
text-primary	#f1f5f9	Headlines, primary content
text-secondary	#94a3b8	Body text, descriptions
text-muted	#475569	Labels, captions, metadata

Glow Effects

Token	Value	Usage
glow-teal	rgba(20, 184, 166, 0.2)	Hero accents, card hover
glow-blue	rgba(59, 130, 246, 0.15)	Button hover, link focus
glow-red	rgba(239, 68, 68, 0.1)	Error states, alerts

Color Hierarchy

- **Teal** is the dominant accent — use for primary CTAs, labels, and visual anchors
- **Blue** is the action color — use for links, buttons, and interactive elements

- **Red** and **Green** are semantic — reserve for alerts/errors and success/confirmations
- **Never use brand colors for large background fills** — they are accents on dark surfaces

Gradient Usage

- Primary gradient: teal (#14b8a6) → blue (#3b82f6) — used for headline accents, button borders
- Apply gradients via `bg-gradient-to-r` or `bg-clip-text text-transparent`
- Keep gradient text to headlines only — never body copy

4. Typography

Font Families

Role	Family	Weight	Source
Display / Headlines	**Space Grotesk**	Bold (700)	Google Fonts
Body	**Inter**	Regular (400), Medium (500)	Google Fonts
Code / Data / Labels	**JetBrains Mono**	Regular (400), Medium (500)	Google Fonts

Type Scale

Name	Size	Weight	Tracking	Usage
Hero Headline	5xl → 7xl → 8xl	Bold	Tight	Hero section only
Section Headline	3xl → 5xl	Bold	Default	Section titles
Section Sub	lg → xl	Regular	Default	Section descriptions
Body	base (16px)	Regular	Default	Paragraph text
Label	sm (14px)	Regular	Widest, Uppercase	Tags, badges, metadata
Code	sm (14px)	Regular	Default	Code blocks, technical data

Typography Rules

- **Headlines** always use Space Grotesk Bold — never Inter for display
- **Body text** always uses Inter — never Space Grotesk for paragraphs
- **Technical labels** (stats, badges, code) use JetBrains Mono
- **Maximum 2 font weights** per section to maintain visual hierarchy
- **Line height:** Headings = tight (1.1–1.2), Body = relaxed (1.6–1.75)
- **Never use ALL CAPS** for headlines — only for small labels (text-xs uppercase tracking-widest)

5. Iconography

Icon System: Lucide React

All icons come from the **Lucide** icon library — a clean, consistent set of line icons.

Approved icons in use:

- Wallet, ArrowLeftRight, Search, Cpu, Coins, Building
- Vote, Lock, Users, Blocks, Trophy
- Menu, X, ChevronDown, ExternalLink, Copy, Check

Icon Rules

- **Line weight:** Default Lucide stroke (2px)
- **Size:** 20px (sm), 24px (default), 32px (lg)
- **Color:** Inherit from parent or use brand color classes
- **Background treatment:** Rounded-lg container with 10% opacity brand color fill (e.g., `bg-qc-blue/10` with `text-qc-blue`)

Icon Don'ts

- **NEVER use clipart, emoji, or filled/illustrated icons**
- Never use icons from mixed icon sets — Lucide only
- Never apply drop shadows or 3D effects to icons
- Never use icons as decorative filler — every icon communicates meaning

6. Tone of Voice

Voice Characteristics

Attribute	We Are	We Are Not
Confidence	"Deploy existing contracts."	"We believe our platform could potentially..."
Technical	"100K TPS. 3-second finality."	"Really fast blockchain technology"
Direct	"Start building on QuarryChain."	"Ready to build on QuarryChain?"
Accessible	"EVM-compatible. Your Solidity works."	"Leveraging deterministic EVM opcodes..."

Writing Principles

1. **State, don't ask.** "Start building." not "Ready to build?"
2. **Show capability, don't compare.** Solana doesn't explain why Ethereum is slow.
3. **Short paragraphs. Bold stats. No walls of text.**
4. **Technical accuracy matters.** Don't oversimplify to the point of inaccuracy.
5. **Two sentences max per feature card.** If it takes more, it's a page, not a card.

Copy Patterns

Headlines: Short, declarative. 3–7 words.

- Good: "Decentralized by design."
- Bad: "A Truly Decentralized Blockchain Network for the Future"

Descriptions: One to two sentences. Lead with the benefit.

- Good: "Non-custodial AMM with liquidity pools, yield farming, and AI-powered contract auditing."
- Bad: "QuarrySwap is a decentralized exchange that allows users to swap tokens, provide liquidity, and earn yield through our innovative farming mechanisms."

CTAs: Action verbs. No questions.

- Good: "Read the Docs" / "Join Discord"
- Bad: "Learn More" / "Get Started Today!"

Labels: Uppercase, tracking-widest, JetBrains Mono.

- Good: "GOVERNANCE" / "BUILD ON QUARRYCHAIN"
- Bad: "About Our Governance" / "Developer Resources"

7. Component Patterns

Cards

- Background: bg-secondary (#0f1019)
- Border: 1px border-white/5
- Border radius: rounded-xl (12px)
- Hover: border-white/10 + spotlight glow effect
- Padding: p-6 (cards) or p-8 (feature cards)
- No drop shadows — use subtle glow instead

Buttons

Primary:

- Border: gradient (teal → blue) at 50% opacity
- Fill: transparent with gradient tint (teal/10 → blue/10)
- Text: white, sm, medium weight
- Hover: increased tint (teal/20 → blue/20) + box-shadow glow
- Padding: px-6 py-3

Secondary (Ghost):

- Border: white/10
- Fill: transparent
- Text: text-secondary
- Hover: border-white/20, text-primary
- Padding: px-6 py-3

Badges / Pills

- Background: bg-[rgba(20,184,166,0.08)]
- Border: border-[rgba(20,184,166,0.15)]
- Text: teal, xs, JetBrains Mono
- Border radius: rounded-full
- Padding: px-3.5 py-1.5

Code Blocks

- Container: bg-secondary, rounded-xl, border white/6
- Header: dot trio (red/yellow/green at 60%), filename, copy button
- Font: JetBrains Mono, sm
- Syntax colors: purple (#c084fc) keywords, teal (#2dd4bf) types, yellow (#fbbf24) strings, blue (#3b82f6) functions, muted (#475569) comments
- Subtle teal box-shadow glow on container

Stat Displays

- Value: text-3xl, font-bold, Space Grotesk, text-primary
- Label: text-xs, uppercase, tracking-widest, JetBrains Mono, text-muted
- Use NumberTicker animation for count-up on scroll

8. Motion & Animation

Principles

- **Purposeful:** Every animation communicates something — entrance, state change, or interactivity
- **Subtle:** Glow expansion, not bounce. Fade, not fly.
- **Performant:** 60fps target. Lazy-load heavy assets.
- **Accessible:** All animations disabled when `prefers-reduced-motion` is set

Entrance Animations

- **BlurFade:** Elements fade up (6px) + blur-in on scroll-into-view
- **Stagger:** Children animate in with 50ms delay between siblings
- **Once:** Entrance animations fire once — never replay on re-scroll

Hover Effects

- **Cards:** Mouse-tracking spotlight (radial gradient follows cursor)
- **Buttons:** Glow expansion, not color change
- **Links:** Color shift to text-primary, 200ms ease

Continuous Animations

- **Hero HexGrid:** Sine-wave deformation + mouse-reactive ripple
- **WireframeGem:** Slow dual-axis rotation
- **Marquee:** Horizontal scroll, pauseOnHover
- **GovernancePreview:** 60s slow rotation on node ring

Timing

- Transitions: 200–300ms ease
- Entrances: 400–600ms ease-out
- Continuous: 20–60s linear infinite
- Count-up: 1.5–2s ease-out

9. Spacing & Layout

Page Structure

- Max width: max-w-7xl (1280px) for content sections
- Narrower: max-w-5xl (1024px) for centered text sections
- Padding: px-4 sm:px-6 lg:px-8
- Section spacing: py-24 lg:py-32

Grid System

- Bento grid: grid md:grid-cols-2 gap-4
- Ecosystem grid: grid sm:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3 gap-4
- Stats: grid grid-cols-3 md:grid-cols-5 gap-4

Vertical Rhythm

- Section label to headline: mb-4
- Headline to subtext: mb-4 to mb-6
- Subtext to content: mb-8 to mb-16
- Card internal: p-6 to p-8, gap-3 between elements

10. Do's and Don'ts

Do

- Use dark mode as the default and only mode (for now)
- Keep copy short, confident, and benefit-driven
- Use teal as the primary accent, blue for actions
- Use Lucide line icons exclusively
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion
- Use blur-fade entrance animations on all sections
- Test on mobile — every component must be responsive

Don't

- Don't use light backgrounds anywhere
- Don't use clipart, stock illustrations, or emoji
- Don't write copy that explains why competitors are bad
- Don't use more than 2 font weights per section
- Don't apply gradients to body text
- Don't add drop shadows — use subtle glows instead
- Don't use questions in CTAs — use statements
- Don't over-animate — not everything needs to move

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